

Happier employees

Keihin Electric Railway in Japan has developed software, which scans the smile of the employees to help them in maximizing cheeriness

researchers have been accused of playing God and tampering with the essence of life. Fears are being expressed that such biological research could lead to the creation of new forms of virulent viruses or an

ultimate biological weapon, which might destroy millions of lives. But it is also a fact that the time has probably come for man to start taking a deeper look into what is really meant by life. There is no doubt that in years to come many other scientists will be able to create different forms of life. Eventually society will have to come to terms with this new scientific development.



J Craig Venter

End of newspapers?

For most us the day starts with having our quota of news from our favourite newspaper, which is printed on large sheets of paper. Is it possible that someday we might start getting our news from an electronic device instead of printed paper? Devices like iPad and Kindle could prove to be a game changer for the newspaper industry. When you can access news from all parts of the world by simply moving your fingers across a beautiful touchscreen, then you might not feel the need for a conventional newspaper. Even with a laptop



iPad - the new newspaper

and PC, getting news from the Internet is quite easy; many net savvy individuals have already become habituated to using these devices to get their news. In future, we might have access to even better electronic devices and that could lead to a larger number of readers getting weaned away from paper newspapers. No one should be surprised if the coming decade sees a big shake-up in the newspaper industry.

HTML5 to change the internet?

HTML5 is on the horizon and it packs lot of conveniences to make us feel ecstatic about it. Major tech companies like Google, are banking heavily on the success of HTML5, which removes the need for extra, optional elements inside the actual code and makes websites load faster. Flash has often been the cause of frustration; the files load too slowly. HTML5 will change the nature of our websites, as it does not rely on Flash for delivering animation. In addition to all this there are many other ways by which HTML5 could bring ease to your browsing activity.

Will Cyborgs become real?

The phrase cyborg stands for cybernetic organisms, which are part human, part machine. The next decade could see a major push towards the creation of cyborgs. Hollywood has over the years shown remarkable fascination with cyborgs, but you don't need to worry, there is hardly any chance of a Terminator like being coming into existence for many decades. What we might see is a trend towards larger number of people getting themselves implanted with chips or other electronic devices for health reasons or simply for convenience. For instance, those suffering from diabetes could have a chip, capable of monitoring and regulating sugar levels, implanted in their body. There could be those who might go in for having small computing devices implanted in their hands or feet for myriad reasons. In 1998 Kevin Warwick, who is now the Professor of Cybernetics at the University of Reading, England, had got a silicon chip embedded in his arm. The chip allowed computers to monitor

Fastest steampowered car

By clocking, 151 mph, in his 25ft long vehicle, Charles Burnett III created a new land-speed record for a steam-powered car on a track in California.



Are Cyborgs going to be reality?

him as he moved around the Department of Cybernetics at the University.

Universal translators

In a world where thousands of languages are spoken, we could certainly do with a "Universal Translator" type of a device. As of now a Universal Translator has mostly been seen in sci-fi TV serials and movies, but it is also a fact that the ability of computer based translators is improving. There is no dearth of websites on the Internet, which offer the facility of translations from one language to another; in many cases the services are entirely free. As of now the translations are done on a word-for-word basis, so the grist of spoken language is often lost. But that might change in the years to come. We could start having computer systems, which can understand the emotional and the social meanings subsumed in a sentence and then translate accordingly. Along with many other companies, Google is currently said to be developing a translator, which will use voice recognition system and a database, to enable a robotic voice to recite the translation in the desired language. So in the years to come, it might become lot easier for you to strike a conversation with someone who has a different linguistic background. 



To boldly go where no man has gone before!